Rift Valley Commercial Bank

Mobile Money Credit Policy Guidelines

Extract for Internal Sandbox Demonstration — Version 1.0

Document owner: Retail Credit Risk Committee

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Scope: Unsecured micro-credit and small business working-capital products originated through mobile-money transaction histories, bank account statements, or approved aggregator feeds.

Note: This synthetic excerpt is designed for demonstration and testing. It does not represent the actual lending policy of any bank, telco, lender, or regulator.

1. Purpose and Operating Principle

The purpose of these guidelines is to provide a consistent credit-policy framework for applications supported primarily by mobile-money transaction history. The bank shall assess whether the applicant has a stable cash-flow pattern, a manageable repayment burden, and no unresolved fraud, sanctions, or identity exceptions before granting unsecured credit.

The policy is intentionally written in plain business language so that credit officers, data engineers, model-risk reviewers, and internal auditors can trace automated decisions back to human-approved policy text.

2. Evidence Sources

The following evidence sources may be used when evaluating an application:

- verified mobile-money statements from an approved provider;
- bank account inflow and repayment records supplied by the applicant or aggregator;
- identity-verification and KYC status from approved compliance systems;
- existing internal loan exposure and repayment performance;
- external bureau or multi-lender exposure data where available.

3. Core Eligibility Standards

The standards below define minimum underwriting requirements for automated approval. Failure to meet a standard does not prohibit a manual review, but it does prohibit straight-through automated approval unless a documented exception is approved by Credit Risk.

3.1 Verified Monthly Net Cash Inflow

Minimum inflow rule. Applications with a verified monthly net cash inflow of less than KES 50,000 are not eligible for unsecured credit approval. The applicant may be declined or referred for manual review, but the system must not issue an automated approval below this threshold.

For this rule, verified monthly net cash inflow means the average monthly inbound customer-controlled funds over the most recent three complete calendar months, excluding reversed transactions, suspected passthrough transfers, internal account movements, and one-time exceptional deposits that cannot be substantiated.

3.2 Account Tenure

Minimum tenure rule. The mobile-money account or linked transaction source should show at least six months of usable history before automated approval. Applications with shorter history may be routed to manual review when alternative evidence is available.

3.3 Repayment Burden

Affordability guide. Projected monthly repayment should ordinarily not exceed 35 percent of verified monthly net cash inflow after considering known active obligations. Exceptions require documented compensating factors.

3.4 Existing Multi-Lender Exposure

Where multi-lender data is available, the underwriting system should identify active obligations across mobile lenders, banks, salary-advance providers, and merchant-credit facilities. Exposure concentration, rapid sequential borrowing, or circular repayment activity must be surfaced for review.

4. Automated Decision Records

Every automated approval, decline, or referral must produce a decision record that can be reconstructed later. The record should include the applicant facts used at decision time, the active policy rule or rules applied, the source evidence supporting those rules, and the decision timestamp.

For audit and model-risk purposes, the bank must be able to answer why a specific application was approved, declined, or referred based on the information known at the time of the decision.

5. Example Decision Outcomes

Applicant	Verified monthly net cash inflow	Automated outcome	Reason
John Mwangi	KES 72,500	Approved	Meets minimum inflow rule.
Esther Kamau	KES 47,800	Declined	Below the minimum inflow rule for automated approval.
David Ochieng	KES 56,300	Approved	Exceeds the minimum inflow rule.

6. Reconstruction Expectations

A later audit should be able to reconstruct the active policy text, the materialized rule, the applicant facts, and the final decision as they existed at decision time. The system should not depend on re-asking a language model to infer the same rule for every application.